

What is Communication?

- The deliberate or accidental transfer of meaning
- Communication springs from the Latin verb *communicare* , which means “to make common”.
- Communication is the deepest core of our human selves.
- We cannot not communicate.

Types of Communication

- Intrapersonal communication—communication with the self
- Interpersonal communication—relationship level of communication
- Group communication—interaction with a limited number of persons
- Public communication— communication designed to inform or persuade audience members

Types of Communication (contd.)

- Online, or machine-assisted communication—building of relationships using computers and the Internet
- Mass communication—transmission of messages which may be processed by gate keepers prior to being sent to large audiences via a channel of broad diffusion

Elements of Communication (Contd.)

1. People

- Senders—persons who formulate, encode, and transmit a message
- Receivers—persons who receive, decode and interpret a message

Elements of Communication (Contd.)

2. Messages—content of a communicative act
3. Channels—medium through which a message is sent
4. Noise—anything that interferes with or distorts the ability to send and receive messages
5. Context—setting

Elements of Communication (Contd.)

6. Feedback—information returned to a message source

- Positive feedback—behavior enhancing response
- Negative feedback—response that extinguishes behavior in progress

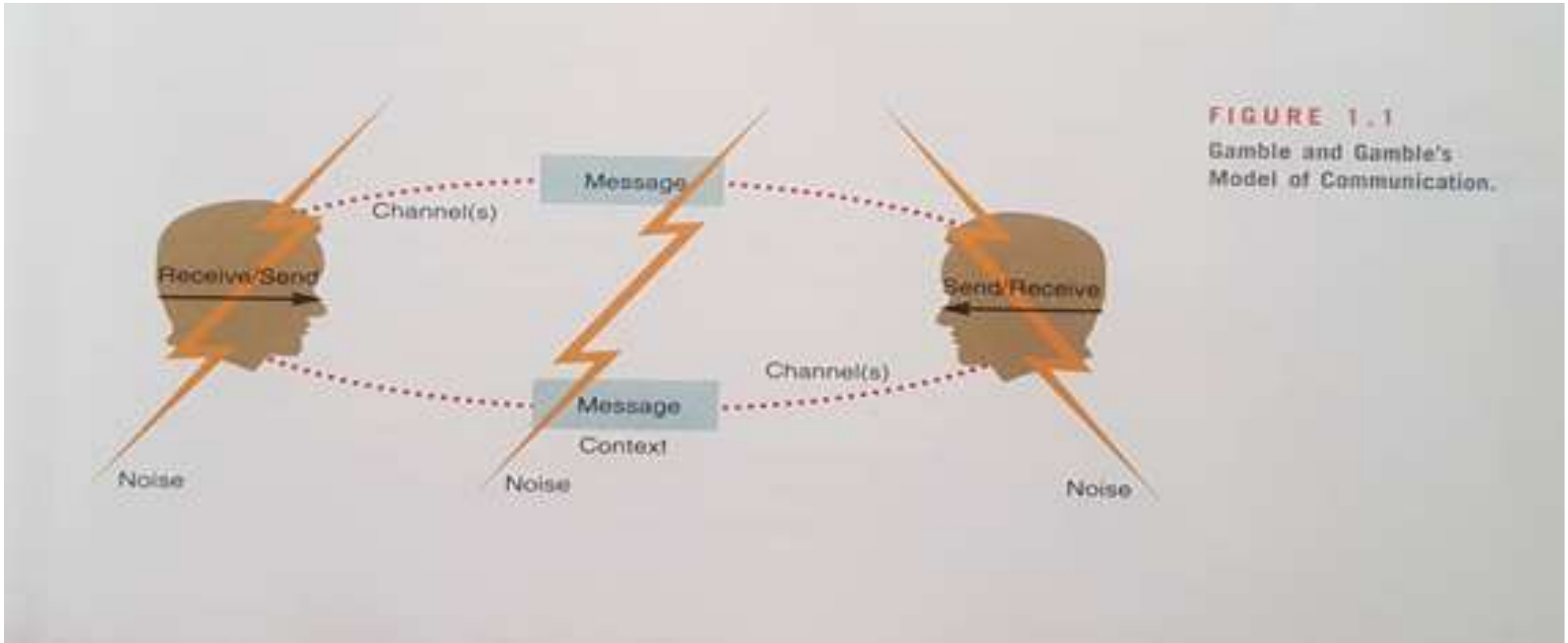
Elements of Communication (Contd.)

6. Feedback (continued)

- Internal feedback—response you give yourself
- External feedback—response from another

7. Effect—communication outcome

Gamble and Gamble's Model of Communication



Communicating in a Digital Age

- Media Content Influences our Thoughts and Feelings
- Media and Computers Influence Our Perceptions of Communication

Main forms of Communication at the workplace **(contd.)**

(1) Internal operational—the communicating done in conducting work within a business, such as giving orders, assembling reports, and writing email.

(2) External operational—work related communication with people outside the business, such as personal selling, telephoning, advertising, and writing messages.

- Messages display a company's etiquette.
- Both internal and external communications are vital to business success.

Main forms of Communication at the workplace **(contd.)**

3) Personal communication— non-business-related exchanges of information and feelings among people.

- Personal communication affects employee attitudes.
- And attitudes affect employee performance.
- The extent of personal communication permitted affects employee attitudes.

Communication networks at the workplace

- Formal Network
 - well-established, usually along operational lines
 - planned
- Informal Network
 - complex
 - dynamic

How Oral and Written Communication differ

Written communication differs from oral communication in that it:

- (1) is more likely to involve creative effort,
- (2) has longer cycles, and
- (3) usually has fewer cycles.

Resulting stress on adaptation

The communication process shows the need for adaptation— an underlying principle in our study of communication.

**“Writing is thinking on paper. Anyone who
thinks clearly should be able to write
clearly about any subject at all.”**

-William Zinsser,
Author
On Writing Well

Language and Meaning: **Helping minds meet**

- What language is
- How language works: Words, things and thoughts
- The Communication of meaning
- Culture and Language
- Gender and language

The Communication of meaning

- Meanings are Denotative and Connotative
- Denotative meaning—dictionary meaning; the objective or descriptive meaning of a word
- Connotative meaning—subjective meaning; one's personal meaning for a word

Culture and Language (contd.)

The Sapir-Whorf Hypothesis

- Sapir-Whorf hypothesis—belief that the labels we use help shape the way we think, our worldview, and behavior
- Linguistic determinism—belief that language influences how we interpret the world
- Linguistic relativity—belief that persons who speak different languages perceive the world differently

Culture and Language (contd.)

- Cultural differences can lead to confused translations
- Culture influences Communication style

Gender and Language

- Sexism in Language
- Gender and speech style
- Qualifiers—tentative phrases
- Tag questions—question between an outright statement and a yes/no question
- Disclaimers—remarks which diminish a statement's importance

Gender and Language (contd.)

- Gender-lects—Deborah Tannen's term for language differences attributed to gender

Language and Power

Men and women have the potential to influence the way others perceive them by communicating in ways that make them appear more

- Confident
- Forceful
- In control of a situation

Problems with meaning: Patterns of miscommunication

Bypassing: confusing meanings

- Bypassing—occurs when individuals think they understand each other, but actually miss each other's meaning

Problems with meaning: Patterns of miscommunication (contd.)

- Evasive and Emotive Language
- Euphemism—substitution of a pleasant word in place of a less pleasant one
- Politically correct language
- Profanity and obscenity: Incivility and the coarsening of Language

Technology and Language use

- Onlinespeak—the protocol of informality that marks electronic communication
- Netiquette—rules of the Internet